

Security Watch

Digit sat down with Larry Clinton of Internet Security Alliance fame to talk about cyber security



Firefox turned 9

It's been 9 long years since Mozilla launched Firefox. Let's have a piece of cake and say Happy Ninth Birthday Firefox!

the latest entrant to the large screen smartphones market. HTC is also offering two new accessories with the One Max – HTC Mini+ and HTC Fetch – which cost ₹7,799 and ₹2,399, respectively. While the HTC Mini+ is a multi-tasking 'mini phone', HTC Fetch is a tracker device for your mobile phone. The company is offering 50 GB of Google Drive storage for two years with the smartphone. Moreover, there's a power flip cover available with the phone for ₹5,999 that provides an additional 1,200 mAh battery, viz 30 percent extra battery power.

The HTC One Max runs Android 4.3 Jelly Bean with HTC Sense 5.5 and BlinkFeed. The smartphone/phablet is powered by a Snapdragon 600 chipset with a 1.7GHz quad-core Krait 300 CPU along with the Adreno 320 GPU and 2 GB of RAM. It comes with 16 GB of built-in storage, and memory card support for up to 64 GB of additional storage. The smartphone has the Ultrapixel camera and 2.1MP front-facing camera.

The smartphone also has the Fingerprint Scan feature that unlocks the phone and launches favourite apps with a swipe. In terms of connectivity, the HTC One Max supports 3G, GPS, Wi-Fi IEEE 802.11 a/ac/b/g/n, Bluetooth 4.0, NFC, DLNA, HTC Connect and microUSB

2.0. The smartphone comes with a 3,300 mAh battery, which is rated to deliver talktime of up to 25 hours.

The One Max is one of the priciest smartphones from HTC, and is expected to take on the likes of Sony Xperia Z Ultra, Samsung Galaxy Note 3 and LG Optimus G Pro. We'll soon come up with a detailed hands on and review of the One Max. Till then, munch on what local players are coming up with.

Intex reveals 6-inch smartphone

At an event held in Delhi in November, Intex unveiled a smartphone that runs on the MediaTek MT6592 chipset that boasts of 'true octa-core processing'. Put simply, this means that all the eight cores of the CPU are active simultaneously making the phone a beast (theoretically).

The device unveiled was a prototype. While the design of the phone is final, Intex hasn't given it a final name (model number) yet. It will be a flagship smartphone in Intex's Aqua series. There will be two variants of the smartphone available – 16 GB and 32 GB. The 16GB variant will be priced under ₹20,000 and the 32GB variant under ₹25,000. The smartphone will be available in January 2014.

Other specifications of the Octa-core Intex smartphone includes 2 GB of RAM and a 6-inch display with a 1280x720 pixels resolution. The octa-core processor is clocked at 1.7 GHz. The rear houses a 13MP camera and the front has a 5MP video-calling



That's not exactly what the phone looks like, but you get the idea

camera. A 2,600mAh battery powers the smartphone. The smartphone will run on Android 4.2 Jelly Bean straight out of the box and Intex says that the device will support OTA updates.

We got to spend some time with the prototype at the event and being a prototype, the device was quite buggy. All the bugs can be expected to be ironed out by the time the device hits store shelves. Considering its size, it's uncomfortable for single hand use. One good thing about the smartphone is that the battery is user replaceable, but the prototype at the event didn't have a removable back.

At 6 inches, the device is quite large and will compete with the likes of the Samsung Galaxy Mega 5.8 and the Huawei Ascend Mate. The 720p resolution on the octa-core Intex smartphone gives the display a pixel density of 244ppi. This isn't bad, but it isn't the best out there either. The reason for using a 720p display in place of a full HD display is, of course, to control the cost of the device.

Coming to the build of the smartphone, it's quite slim measuring in at 7mm in thickness. The rear of the smartphone also has dual Yamaha 1420 speakers with an output of 1.2W. With the octa-core chipset, the smartphone will be capable of playing 2K as well as 4K videos.

Overall, the Octa-core powered Intex smartphone looks promising but we'd like to get our hands on the final retail unit to see its true potential.

Micromax is expected to launch an octa-core smartphone sometime next year and Huawei has also confirmed the P6S that will run on an octa-core CPU.

Huawei unveils Ascend W2

Huawei has announced a new Windows Phone 8-based smartphone, Ascend W2. Powered by a Qualcomm Snapdragon dual-core 1.4GHz processor, the Huawei Ascend W2 features a 4.3-inch IPS WVGA (480x800) LCD display. The Huawei Ascend W2 sports a 5MP rear camera with 720P video recording and playback. It has 512 MB of RAM and 8 GB of ROM. In terms of connectivity, the Ascend W2 supports Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g/n, Bluetooth 3.0 and micro USB 2.0. The smartphone comes with a 1,700 mAh battery, which is expected to deliver talktime of 9.5 hours.

The HUAWEI Ascend W2 automatically syncs to a 7GB of free SkyDrive cloud storage account and entertainment content such as music and videos, on PCs, tablets and consoles can be shared with Xbox Music and Xbox Live. The Ascend W2 will be available in multiple colours – black, blue, yellow and red.

The smartphone is expected to be available in the Indian market soon.



5.9 inches – Now that's a huge phone!